

7th Annual Virtual Show 2026 MDIS NOVEL (V)IRIS SHOW

SOMEWHERE OVER THE RAINBOW

Sponsored by

MT. DIABLO IRIS SOCIETY

An Affiliate of

The American Iris Society



LUNAR RING Tall Bearded 2020 Keith Keppel

VIRTUAL IRIS SHOW

Entries will be accepted

September 1, 2025 to August 31, 2026, midnight PDT

Open to Everyone

Registration Free

After the deadline, AIS judges will judge the iris and you will be notified by email the results of the judging.

Virtual Ribbons and Virtual Rosettes will be emailed to you.

**A Show Video will be produced and available on the
Mt Diablo Iris YouTube Channel**

**A People's Choice will be chosen by YouTube followers and
announced in December.**

Why a virtual show? Ask George Bernard Shaw "So the anxious donor offered flowers. "Surely, you must be fond of flowers, Mr. Shaw?" "So I am of children," he replied, "but I don't cut off their heads, and stick them in pots about the room." George Bernard Shaw

RULES

- This virtual show is approved by the American Iris Society. It is being held and judged under the rules and regulations of AIS as set forth in the latest edition of *the Handbook for Judges and Show Officials* and any subsequent rules and regulations approved by the AIS Board of Directors. These rules and regulations may not be violated.
- Accredited judges of The American Iris Society will judge all entries in the Horticultural Divisions. The judges' decisions will be final. Any award may be withheld at their discretion.
- **Exhibitors may obtain an exhibitor number, unique registration form, and instructions by contacting MDISVirtual@gmail.com**
- **The registration must be prepared by the exhibitor.**
- This is a VARIETY/CULTIVAR show, organized into sections according to type of iris (e.g. Tall Bearded, Spuria, etc) and in alphabetical order by name of the cultivar within each section and group. Each cultivar constitutes a separate class. Only correctly named cultivars and seedlings will be judged.
- **An exhibitor may enter 25 cultivars or seedlings in the single stalk classes, but only one cultivar or seedling in each class, with a total of 100 entries.**
- The virtual show chair may divide, sub-divide, combine, or create sections and groups of entries as necessary.
- Correct and complete information must appear on the registration form for all entries: the exhibitor number, the section, section abbreviation, class, correct name of cultivar or seedling, and the photo name.
- Youth exhibitors (under 19) may enter exhibits in the Youth Horticulture Division or the Open Horticulture Division but not both in the same show.
- Entries from the same family can be made of iris grown in the same garden. Family members may enter as a unit or individually, but not both, in the same show.
- Show judges are permitted to exhibit in the show only in sections they are not judging. In the case of an emergency the show chair(s) may allow an exhibitor who is a qualified judge to serve as a virtual show judge.
- **All photos must have been taken since September 1, 2025 by the exhibitor whose name appears on the registration form. All iris must have been grown by the exhibitor. Cropped photos are acceptable. Photos must be combined into one picture (JPG file) known as 4UP.**
- **Entries must be submitted by email by midnight, August 31, 2026, to MDISVirtual@gmail.com. The email should include the registration form and the entry pictures. Use GOOGLE DRIVE to attach multiple picture files, but let us know if you are sharing or adding to that GOOGLE DRIVE.**
- Entries will be organized and uploaded to folders and submitted to the judges by September 2, 2026. Judges will judge using the time they require and using whatever methods work best for them.
- As this is an accredited virtual show, exhibitors will receive virtual ribbons, virtual rosettes, and virtual certificates by email following judging.

By submitting an entry, you are confirming that you grew the iris, photographed the iris, and completed the registration.

Note: If you choose to print this booklet, PRINT ON BOTH SIDES AND FLIP ON THE SHORT EDGE. It will require two pieces of paper. Fold.

Steps for entering the MDIS Virtual Show

Step 1 – Email MDISVirtual@gmail.com that you would like an ENTRY NUMBER so that you can submit photo entries. Let us know if you are entering in the YOUTH DIVISION

Apply for an ENTRY NUMBER even if you are unsure you will be entering photos. Do this NOW. You will receive: a unique registration form, a show bulletin, and other explanatory pages. These will be WORD documents. (PDF available upon request)

Step 2 – **Take photos of YOUR iris, GROWN by you, PHOTOGRAPHED by you, and ENTERED by you.** Please take and **combine four unique photos into one file with the cultivar name**, correctly named, (JPEG,JPG only, less than 1 MB}}

- 1 Photo of a single iris from above (TOP)
- 2 Photo of the same iris flower from the front (FRONT)
- 3 Photo of the same iris from the side (SIDE)
- 4 Photo of the entire iris plant, from the ground up to the top of The terminal flower (STALK)

Sample pictures Divisions I, II, and III



1-Top View



2-Front View



3. Side View



4-Full-stalk



Combined

This is known as a 4UP picture.

- Be mindful of backgrounds. Move any items that might detract from the flower.
- Crop the picture to include JUST the flower/stalk.

<https://youtu.be/9znsLlfcwrk> Video will help your photography.

You MAY use a backdrop to make it easier for the judges to see your plant but this is NOT required.

ARTISTIC DESIGN –designed and photographed by the exhibitor

- A. Photo from the front (FRONT)
- B. Total design from the side (SIDE)
- C. Photo of the 3X5 card with the design explanation

Combine the three photos into one file as for the other entries.

Artistic Design photos should have a backdrop

Step 3 - Naming photos for the MDIS VIRTUAL SHOW

Entries with people in the picture will be disqualified.

- **Combine four photos, top, front, side, stalk into one file.**

In WORD *insert* the pictures into a landscape 11X8.5 or 14X8.5
In EXCEL, do the same and manipulate the positions of the pictures as you wish.

In any photoshop program use a landscape format up to 16X11.
In PUBLISHER,(PC) insert pictures into TABLOID, one at a time, then manipulate positions and size.

There is a separate file available explaining each of these procedures. Name 4UP with Section Letter and cultivar name.

- All photos become the property of MDIS.
- If used for publication, you will receive photo credits.
- The virtual show committee will exercise all possible care but is not responsible for loss or damage to entries. We will respond within 48 hours to any inquiries and will acknowledge receipt of any entries within 48 hours. **If you do NOT hear from us, resend your email or contact us.**

Step 4 - Complete the REGISTRATION FORM listing each of your photo entries. Column sizes are fixed width. Please do not adjust them in any way. There is an explanation sheet sent to you on how to add iris to the registration form.

Step 5 - Email ALL photos and registration sheet to
MDISVirtual@gmail.com by midnight PDT, August 31, 2026

IN A NUTSHELL:

1. Email MDISVirtual@gmail.com and ask for an entry number
2. Take four required pictures of each iris you enter
3. **Combine your pictures into one file with the cultivar name on the picture.** Name the file with section, cultivar name.
E.G. AThat'sAllFolks would be Tall Bearded (A) entry
You will **send only one picture**, the combination of all four required pictures with only the name of the cultivar on it.
4. Complete the registration form
5. Email the photos and your completed registration form to;
MDISVirtual@gmail.com by midnight PDT August 31, 2026
(GOOGLE Drive works well for this)
6. **You will receive an email confirmation within 48 hours**
Contact us if you do not receive a confirmation !!

ENTRIES

Specifying the Class on the REGISTRATION is required only as specified.
The Class abbreviations required are indicated below.

DIVISION I – HORTICULTURAL

Section A Tall Bearded

Section B Miniature Dwarf Bearded

Section C Standard Dwarf Bearded

Section D Intermediate Bearded

Section E Border Bearded

Section F Miniature Tall Bearded

Section G Space Age – Required: **Specify Class**

Section H Novelty Bearded– Includes broken color, flat tops, multi-petaled, etc. **Specify Class-TB, IB, etc.**

Section I Reblooming – Required: **Specify Class TB, IB, etc.**

Section J Siberian

Section K Louisiana

Section L Spuria

Section M Japanese

Section N Californica

Section P Historic Iris - Varieties of **TB introduced** at least 30 years earlier.1996 and before (Judges may divide by form)

REQUIRED - year of introduction on registration form in **Class**.

Section Q Aril (AR) (Class 1) Arilbred (AB) (Class 2)

Section R Species (Class 1) & Species-cross (Class 2)

Section S Miscellaneous – Bulbous iris and any iris not included in other sections.*

DIVISION II – SEEDLING* (registered under name of originator)

Section V Bearded **Specify Class***

Section W Beardless - **Specify Class***

DIVISION III - YOUTH

Section Y Any type of iris grown and exhibited by those 18 years of age and younger. **Specify Class**

DIVISION IV – EDUCATION

Section EDU – Electronic exhibit relating to iris, hybridizers, shows

JUDGING

Cultural Perfection 50% How well is it grown for this particular variety or species? Is there damage; brown spots or leaf tips, infestations of insects, poor symmetry of growth, or other factors showing poor vigor for the specimen?

Presentation 25% If in a pot, is the pot clean? Are there weeds surrounding the plant? Could spent blossoms have been removed? Generally, is the plant/flower being presented with its best face?

Photo Quality 25% : Is the image in strong sunlight with disruptive shadows? Is there a disruptive background detracting from the flowers? Are all four correct views photographed?

DIVISION V – ARTISTIC DESIGN*

The theme is **SOMEWHERE OVER THE RAINBOW**

Section Z Each arrangement must contain Iris as the dominant flower.

Arrangements must relate to The Wizard of Oz. Limit one arrangement per person per class. Containers to be furnished by the exhibitor. Backdrops are encouraged.

Class 1 – 12 inches tall or less

Class 2 – Over 12 inches tall

Class 3- Youth Under 19

- No artificial flowers, flags, nor treated fresh materials may be used. Accessories and dried materials are allowed. No flags of any country are allowed.
- 3X5 Card photo or a digital file will be used to explain the entries.
- Exhibitors will complete a registration form.
- Arrangements will be judged by AIS judges
- Submit two pictures of your arrangement (front and side) and one picture of your explanation. Combine them into one file.
- Name that single file with your registration number, section, class, and Title of Arrangement. E.G. 01Z1WizardOfOz

The complete scale of points used by AIS for judging designs -Total 100

Conformance to Theme and class 10 points

Design Subtotal.....35 points

A) Balance 5

E) Dominance 5

B) Proportion5

F) Contrast 5

C) Scale 5

G) Unity 5

D) Rhythm 5

Color Use 20 points

Creative Expression (originality) 20 points

Distinction 15 points

AWARDS

- AIS Virtual Ribbons may be awarded for First Place, Second Place, Third Place, and Honorable Mention. Only one First-Place ribbon (blue), one Second-Place ribbon (red), and one Third-Place ribbon (white) may be awarded to any given cultivar in any given section. As many Virtual Honorable Mention ribbons (pink) as quality merit may be awarded. (If there are three entries for 'That's All Folks', then only one blue, red, and white ribbon can be awarded.)
- AIS Virtual Best of Section Rosettes will be awarded in each section where there are at least three exhibitors and five or more entries.
- AIS Special Award Horticulture Virtual Rosettes, when requirements are met, will be awarded to 1st and 2nd Runners-up when there are more than 10 entries in a section and at the Judges' discretion to not more than 10% of the entries.
- An AIS Silver Medal and Virtual Certificate (and YOUTH) will be awarded for the largest number of blue ribbons and an AIS Bronze Medal and Virtual Certificate (and YOUTH) for the second largest number of blue ribbons. Adult medals require at least five exhibitors and 20 entries. Youth medals require two youth and ten entries. In the case of a tie, red ribbons will be counted, and if still tied, white ribbons will be counted. If it remains a tie, two Silver Medals and no Bronze will be awarded. If the tie is for Bronze Medal then two Bronze Medals will be awarded.
- The Best Entry of Show receives a Virtual Certificate and Virtual Best of Show Rosette.
- Runners-up (two) to Best of Show receive a Virtual certificate.
- *Best Seedling receives an Exhibition Certificate (EC) and a Rosette. The EC will be awarded to any seedling receiving five or more votes from fully accredited AIS judges attending any show in the calendar year. Seedling ribbons do not count toward medals nor are seedlings eligible for Best of Show. Electronic ballots will be provided to the judges by the show chair. Completed ballots will be forwarded to the AIS Exhibition Reports chair.
- *Bulbous irises are eligible to receive Virtual ribbons, section Virtual Rosettes, and the Virtual ribbons are included in the tally for Silver and Bronze Medals and Certificates. However, these entries are not eligible for the Best Specimen of Show Virtual award. Artistic Design ribbons are **not** included in the medal count but the best Artistic Design will receive a Virtual Rosette and Virtual Certificate.
- Outstanding Education Exhibits eligible for Bronze Medal.

Judging will begin September 1, 2026. Exhibitors will be notified by email.

THE MT. DIABLO IRIS SOCIETY

The Mt. Diablo Iris Society was founded in Antioch on January 14, 1960. It is a non-profit Society and exists for the purpose of stimulating and fostering interest in the propagation, culture, and hybridizing of the genus Iris, in the scientific and horticultural education of all those interested in learning about any phase of the genus Iris, and in the protection of these plants in their native habitat.

The Society primarily meets at 1:00 p.m. on the second Sunday of each month in Pleasant Hill or San Ramon. For exact location and exceptions contact the Mt. Diablo Iris Society President. Visitors are always welcome.

MEMBERSHIP

Memberships in the Mt. Diablo Iris Society are available at \$12.50 per year, or \$30.00 for three years, per family unit residing at the same mailing address. Mail check to Sergey Melnikov, 27901 Farm Hill Dr, Hayward, CA 94542.

2026 President: Jeff Bennett

Jeff13Bennett@gmail.com

2026 Show Chairs

Mary Sindicic

Jan Blaedel MDISVirtual@gmamil.com

Watch the 2025 Virtual Iris Show videos on YouTube

All Entries – 45 minutes <https://youtu.be/qVXp-05BNwo>

Virtual Award Show https://youtu.be/qPLeOyuBv_c



Find us on Facebook
Mt Diablo Iris Society



@MtDiabloIris

Subscribe to the MDIS YouTube Channel

https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCvVNnNV_OykOZO1vgGoWU2A



We urge you to join The American Iris Society.

Various types of memberships are available. Full membership - \$45/year, Print membership \$30/year, E-membership \$15/year, Youth membership \$8-\$12/year. Inquiries/checks should be sent to the AIS Membership Secretary, Jean Richter, 1226 High Street, Alameda, CA 94501 or memsec@irises.org.